

NIGHT BIRDS

As the sun sets, most birds settle down to sleep, but some are just waking up. Owls and other birds that feed and fly in the dark are called nocturnal birds. They come out at night to find animals to eat and also because many of their enemies

are asleep! Owls hoot loudly to one another in the dead of night—they are often heard but rarely seen.

Owls can fly without making a noise because special fringed feathers slow down the air as it rushes over their wings.

Slow, silent swoop

In the dark, barn owls use their ears, not their eyes, to find food. They can even hear a tiny mouse munching on a seed.

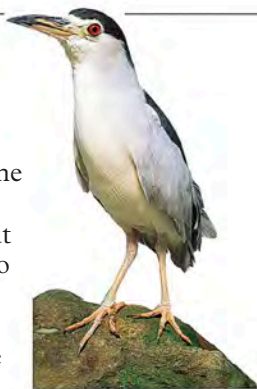


Did you spot this nightjar?

Short tail

Spot the bird

During the day, nightjars sleep on the ground. Their feathers are the color of leaves, so if they don't move, foxes and falcons won't find them.



Night fishing

Waders, like this black-crowned night heron, feed in shallow water. So if the tide is out in the middle of the night, that is when they fish.

